

OptiScan — 0DTE Command Center

How-to guide & daily playbook · private research tool · signals only, never advice

1 · One-time setup

1. Open a terminal in the project folder: `cd Downloads\optiscan-main`
2. Install once: `npm install`
3. Copy `.env.local.example` to `.env.local` and set `POLYGON_API_KEY` to your paid real-time key. Free keys are 15-minute delayed, which means practice mode only.
4. Start the app: `npm run dev` then open `http://localhost:8780`
5. Click **Alerts On** once so the browser can send desktop notifications. Optional: open `/settings` to choose Private vs Public wording mode.

Keep the app running during market hours — the 1-second scanner, alert tracking, and popups all live inside it.

2 · Daily routine (the template)

When (ET)	What to do
9:15 – 9:30	Launch the app. Open /now . Let the loop warm up for about a minute. Check the pill says “Loop 1000ms”.
9:30 – 10:30	Prime window. Watch /now : speed, direction chips (UP / DOWN / CHOPPY), volume surge, HOD/LOD tags. Popups fire on triggers — read the label first, then the why.
On each popup	Run the 30-second checklist (section 3). Decide: Watch, Journal, Snooze, or Ignore. Considering a trade? Click the row on /now for the Contract Reality Check FIRST.
If trade taken	Hit “Mark Trade Taken” on the popup so it links to the alert. Fill in exit price and reasons the same day, while you’re still honest with yourself.
3:15 – 4:00	Late-Day Risk flags appear — the theta cliff. Historically the worst window to open new 0DTE longs.
After close	Spend 5 minutes in /alert-lab : which alerts ran, which were false positives, and did anything you skipped end up ripping.
Friday	Weekly report in /alert-lab : false-positive rate, average max move, best and worst label types, journal win rate. This page decides what you trade next week.

3 · The 30-second popup checklist

- **Direction line:** UP = calls side in play. DOWN = puts side in play. CHOPPY = no clean side — stand down.
- **Label:** “A+ 0DTE Call/Put Watch” is the strongest tier. “Wait for Pullback”, “Chase Risk”, “Too Choppy”, “Spread Too Wide” are the app telling you why NOT.
- **Move status:** Continuation = still going. Extended-But-Tradable = late but structured. Chase Risk or Exhausted = the move already happened.
- **Worth-it verdict and the risk chips** (Spread, Premium, Theta, IV): two Highs is usually a skip no matter the score.
- **Confirms / Invalidates:** these two lists ARE the trade plan — your entry trigger and your exit trigger, written out for you.

4 · The pages

Page	What it's for
/now	The command center. Live 1-second table: speed in %/min, direction, surge, VWAP side, HOD/LOD, Call Watch vs Put Watch, risk chips, labels. Click any row for the Contract Reality Check — best call and best put with breakeven, needed move vs likely move, ratings, and the options-pressure read.
/ (Scanner)	The slower swing radar (15–120 second polls): momentum and unusual-flow tabs, plus a detail drawer with greeks and a payoff chart.
/alert-lab	The scoreboard. Every alert plus what happened after it (1m / 3m / 5m / 15m / 30m / 1h / close), false positives, whether the call or put side worked, the weekly report, and the trade journal.
/settings	Private vs Public wording, popup and sound toggles, capture thresholds, Discord (off by default, manual confirm).
/review	Plain-English explanation of how the whole system works and its honest limits.

5 · Reading the scores

Score	What it means	Rule of thumb
Setup Score (0–100)	Overall setup quality: momentum 20, volume 15, VWAP/levels 15, contract liquidity 25, spread 10, 0DTE fit 10, timing 10, minus up to 25 for risk.	90+ is A+ tier. 70+ is interesting. Below 60, ignore.
Call Watch / Put Watch	How aligned the tape AND the contracts are for each side, scored separately.	One side 70+ while the other is under 40 = clean directional read. Both middling = chop.
0DTE Contract Score	Is THIS contract tradable: spread 30, volume 20, OI 10, delta zone 15, IV 10, time left 10, premium sanity 5.	Below 35 = structurally bad contract no matter what the chart says.
Option Still Worth It	After the move already made: continuation quality + contract quality + time left.	The verdict text matters more than the number.
Risk Score (0–100)	Structural red flags only: spread, thin market, chop, exhaustion, hot IV, late day. Big moves are NOT penalized. No news is NOT penalized.	75+ is the extreme / auto-skip tier.

6 · Label cheat sheet (private mode)

Label	Meaning	Typical handling
A+ 0DTE Call Watch / Put Watch	Setup 90+, clear direction, contracts workable.	Highest-attention tier. Reality check, then decide.
0DTE Call Watch / Put Watch	Directional bias with workable contracts.	Watch for the confirm list to fire.
Bullish / Bearish 0DTE Setup	Direction is clear but contracts or score aren't there yet.	Watchlist, not action.
Momentum Continuation	Move still going; no clean side-call yet.	Re-check on the next popup.
Wait for Pullback	Extended — an entry here is chasing.	Patience. The invalidate list is your line.
Chase Risk	Extended AND decelerating.	Usually a skip — classic reversal shape.
Too Choppy	Whipsaw tape, no efficiency.	Skip. Chop eats 0DTE premium in both directions.
Spread Too Wide / Premium Too Expensive	The contract is structurally bad even if the chart is right.	Skip the contract (you can still watch the stock).
Skip	Move exhausted.	Done. Next.

7 · Contract Reality Check — before ANY trade

Click the ticker's row on /now. You get the best-ranked call and put with:

- **Spread %** with a Tight / OK / Wide rating — remember you pay the spread twice, fast.
- **Breakeven** plus “needs X% vs about Y% likely left.” If needed is bigger than likely, the premium has already priced in your move.
- **Volume, open interest, delta, theta** with a Good / Fair / Thin liquidity rating.
- **Options pressure:** call vs put volume and dollars. Confirmation context only — NOT institutional certainty.

The app never picks the cheapest, the farthest out-of-the-money, or the highest-volume contract — and neither should you.

8 · Friday review — 15 minutes that pay for the data

1. Open the weekly report in /alert-lab.
2. False-positive rate above ~50%? Raise the capture threshold in /settings, or trade only the A+ tier next week.
3. Best label type by average max move: that's your candidate edge. Trade ONLY that pattern next week, small.
4. Worst label type: stop even watching those.
5. Journal win rate vs alert quality: good alerts but losing trades means the problem is execution, not the scanner. Your reason/mistake notes will show which part.

9 · House rules

- The app never places trades and never says buy or sell. Its scores are heuristics with **no backtested edge** until YOUR Alert Lab data proves one.

- 0DTE reality: theta decays by the hour, spreads are paid twice within minutes, reversals are violent. The app flags these — flagging is not removing.
- Delayed data (free key) is practice/logging mode only. Never trade 0DTE off 15-minute-old prints.
- Public mode is for screenshots and streams — it never shows call/put wording and is machine-checked for banned phrases.
- Midpoint “entry” prices are not guaranteed fills. Verify everything in your broker.

OptiScan is a private research and alert-measurement tool. Educational market signals only — not financial advice, not a recommendation service, no order placement.